Seeing Through Photographs

Today's goal • 3/3 items

Module 1
Introduction to Seeing Through Photographs

Module 2
One Subject, Many Perspectives

Part I: Introduction
✓ Introduction to Module 1
Reading • 2 min
✓ Artistic Equivalents
Reading • 2 min
✓ Vik Muniz on Photographing the Familiar
Video • 3 min

Part II: Telescopes and Cameras
✓ Introduction to Part II: Surface, Scale, and Technology
Video • 2 min
✓ Practical Scenario
Real-world application • 5 min
✓ Moons and Surfaces
Reading • 5 min
✓ Hear More: Sarah Meister on Eugène Atget. Pendant l'éclipse. 1912
Video • 3 min
✓ Hear More: Liz Deschenes on Tilt/Swing (360° field of vision, version 1), 2009
Video • 1 min
✓ Surface, Scale, Technology
Dialogue • 15 min

Part III: Seeing the Unseen
✓ Introduction to Part III: Man on the Moon
Video • 2 min
✓ Photographs by NASA
Reading • 2 min
✓ Hear More: Sarah Meister on U.S.G.S. and NASA, Surveyor III. Surface of the Moon, Day 319, W-F. 1967
Video • 1 min
✓ Practical Scenario
Real-world application • 5 min
✓ Who Does the Moon Belong To?
Reading • 4 min

Part IV: It's Only a Paper Moon
✓ Introduction to Part IV: Vernacular and Fine Art Photographs of the Moon
Video • 3 min
✓ Moon Phases
Reading • 6 min
✓ Hear More: Sarah Meister on Ansel Adams. Moonrise, Hernandez, New Mexico. 1941
Video • 3 min
✓ Man on the Moon and Paper Moons
Dialogue • 15 min

Part V: Review and Respond
✓ Optional Readings and Resources
Reading • 10 min
✓ Practice Memory Check
Practice Assignment • Grade: 100%
✓ Optional Discussion Prompts and Creative Challenges
Reading • 10 min

Module 3
Documents and the Documentary

Part I: Introduction
✓ Introduction to Module 3
Reading • 2 min
✓ Sarah Meister on Documents and the Documentary
Video • 3 min

Part II: Framing Reality
✓ Facts and Fictions
Reading • 6 min
✓ Fictions and Facts
Reading • 6 min
✓ Practical Scenario
Real-world application • 5 min
✓ Hear More: Mike Mandel on Evidence, 1977
Video • 4 min
✓ Hear More: Thomas Demand on Room (Zimmer), 1996
Video • 1 min

Part III: Words and Pictures
✓ Artist Spotlight: Dorothea Lange
Reading • 4 min
✓ Practical Scenario
Real-world application • 5 min
✓ Hear More: Sarah Meister on Dorothea Lange. Migrant Mother. 1936
Video • 2 min
✓ Hear More: Sarah Meister on Dorothea Lange. On the Road to Los Angeles, California. March 1937
Video • 1 min
✓ Artist Spotlight: Gordon Parks
Reading • 4 min

Part IV: Focus on New Documents, 1967
✓ Introduction to Part IV: Sarah Meister on New Documents
Video • 3 min
✓ New Documents: Arbus, Friedlander, and Winogrand
Reading • 4 min

Part V: Review and Respond
✓ Practice Memory Check
Practice Assignment • Grade: 100%
✓ Optional Discussion Prompts and Creative Challenges
Reading • 10 min
✓ Optional Readings and Resources
Reading • 10 min

Module 4
One and Another

Part I: Introduction
✓ Introduction to Module 4
Reading • 2 min
✓ Sarah Meister on Photography and Multiplicity
Video • 2 min

Part II: Albums and Books
○ **Artwork Spotlight: Frances Benjamin Johnston's The Hampton Album, 1899-1900**
Reading • 2 min
○ Hear More: Sarah Meister on Frances Benjamin Johnston. The Hampton Album. 1899-1900
Video • 1 min
○ Practical Scenario
Real-world application • 5 min
○ Photo Books
Reading • 8 min

Part III: Bodies of Work
○ Photo Series
Reading • 13 min
○ Hear More: Nicholas Nixon on The Brown Sisters, 1975–2022
Video • 1 min
○ Practical Scenario
Real-world application • 5 min
○ Hear More: Sohrab Hura on Snow, 2015–ongoing
Video • 5 min

Part IV: One from Many
○ One from Many
Reading • 8 min
○ Hear More: Irina Rozovsky on Miracle Center, 2019–ongoing
Video • 5 min

Part V: Review and Respond
○ Practice Memory Check
Practice Assignment • 30 min
○ Optional Discussion Prompts and Creative Challenges
Reading • 10 min
○ Optional Readings and Resources
Reading • 10 min
○ Optional Mid-Course Survey
Reading • 5 min

Module 5
Constructing Narratives, Challenging Histories

Module 6
Pictures of People

Module 7
Ocean of Images

Artwork Spotlight: Frances Benjamin Johnston's The Hampton Album, 1899-1900

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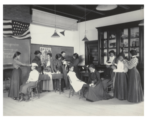


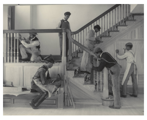
Frances Benjamin Johnston. *Physiology. Class in emergency work* from The Hampton Album. 1899–1900. Platinum print, 7 1/2 × 9 1/2" (19.1 × 24.1 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Gift of Lincoln Kirstein

When a mysterious leather-bound album full of platinum photographs arrived at MoMA in 1965, the photography curators were captivated. At first, it was not known who took the 159 photographs in the album, but through diligent research they discovered the photographer: a woman by the name of Frances Benjamin Johnston. Today Johnston's album is one of many in MoMA's collection, and you'll see another example of an album by Blanche Parker in Module 5.

In 1895 Frances Benjamin Johnston established her own commercial portrait studio in Washington D.C. while pursuing a career as an artist. She took these photographs as part of a commission for the Hampton Institute, which was founded after the American Civil War to provide education and practical training to recently emancipated African Americans, and soon thereafter, Native Americans.

Her photographs were carefully composed and directed, depicting people engaged in both vocational and academic pursuits. Because the album holds so many photographs, it is able to show a remarkably detailed look at what life at the school was like, showcasing the students' hard work and the aspirational goals of the school's curriculum. Exhibited at the 1900 Exposition Universelle in Paris, the series won the grand prize and was lauded by both the public and the press.

Today, Johnston's Album is one of many in MoMA's collection. We'll see another album by Blanche Parker in Module 5.



Frances Benjamin Johnston. *Stairway of the Treasurer's Residence: Students at Work* from The Hampton Album. 1899–1900. Platinum print, 7 9/16 x 9 9/16" (19.2 x 24.3 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Gift of Lincoln Kirstein

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